Caleb Sponheim, PhD

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Quantitative UX researcher and AI subject-matter expert with 10+ years of experience translating research into bestselling courses, internal AI systems, and organizational strategy.

SKILLS

Research & AI: Quantitative UX research • Statistics & experimental design • AI experience design • AI-assisted research workflows • Programming (Python, R, MATLAB)
Training & Consulting: Corporate training • Curriculum design • Executive workshops
Communication: Public speaking • On-camera • Long-form writing • Cross-functional communication

EXPERIENCE

Senior Experience Specialist, AI Lead **April 2026 - Present**
Senior Experience Specialist January 2026 - April 2026
Experience Specialist July 2023 - January 2026
Nielsen Norman Group (NN/G)

- Led AI direction across NN/G as the first head of NN/G's AI functional group: setting AI processes and policies, advising on org-wide adoption, and building tooling
- Designed, built, and maintained NN/G's institutional AI agent and internal automation platform: a production system across company systems with 10+ live automations spanning all company business units, along with a fully-featured conversational AI agent
- Developed Designing AI Experiences (NN/G's top-enrolling course since its launch), along with Research w/ AI and Practical AI for Professionals; trained 1,000+ professionals and delivered enterprise workshops for multinational clients
- Served as primary AI subject-matter expert at NN/G; quoted as an expert source in TIME, Axios, CNET, and Futurism on AI behavior and design
- Delivered keynote talks on AI at international conferences "Humanized AI Is Distracting Your Customers" at UX on the Beach 2026 (Venice, Italy); "Humanized AI is a Trap" at WaysConf 2025 (Krakow, Poland).
- Mentored two junior employees and managed an intern

Research Scientist **August 2017 - July 2023**
University of Chicago

- Used generative ML approaches to uncover links between brain activity and movement; co-author on six peer-reviewed publications (700+ citations, Google Scholar)
- Collaborated with 10+ researchers and engineers to build a brain-machine interface enabling paralyzed participants to control virtual and robotic limbs with brain activity
- Secured $300k+ three-year engineering fellowship from the Department of Defense
- Delivered recommendations on the lifespan of brain implants by analyzing 6000+ datasets

EDUCATION

Ph.D. Computational Neuroscience *University of Chicago, 2023*
B.A. Psychology *Grinnell College, 2015*